COMMUNICATION & ARGUMENTATION

Nicoletta Di Blas – Introduction

People

- Teacher: Nicoletta Di Blas (HOC-LAB)
- Assistant: Giacomo Cassano

Plato’s cave

Course goal(s)

- Equip students with basic & advanced communication skills, on:
  - How to be clear
  - How to be persuasive
- … with a focus on the relevance of the audience/addressee

Learning to communicate

- Theory
- Imitation
  - Find gurus/examples…
- Practice
  - Gradual challenges

What this course is about

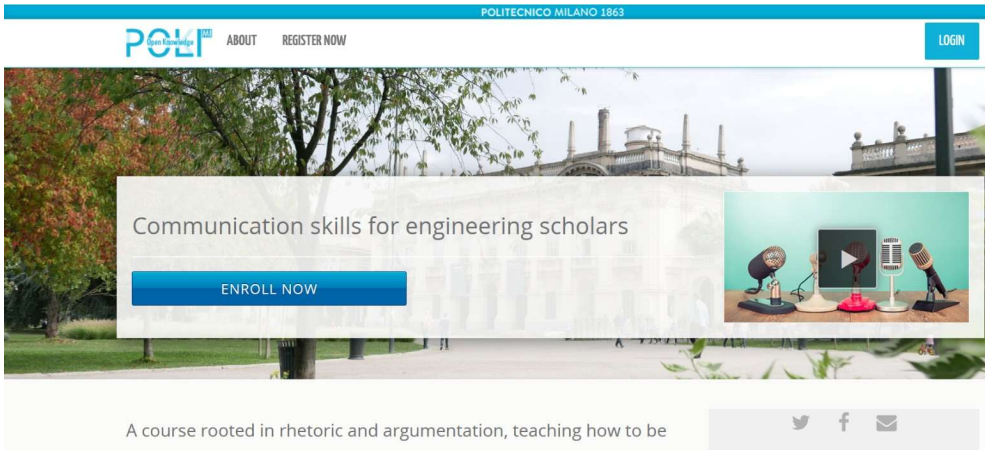
- Linguistics (basic elements)
- Rhetoric
- Presentation skills
- Argumentation
  - … and manipulation
- Grant-writing

Methodology

- CLASSES: on campus, synchronous
- LABS: on campus, synchronous
- MOOC on communication
  - Massive Online Open Course (POK- COURSERA)
- TUTORING on the final project

All the above mixed: see calendar in WEBEEP

MOOC on communication



Organized into weeks; includes quizzes
~3 hours of videos

Materials

- Slides
- MOOCs (videos, transcripts)
- Background readings
  - Papers, excerpts from books…
- Additional resources (optional)

All materials in WEBEEP

Exam

1. MOOC: final certificate required
2. TEST: 6 open-ended questions
   - 60% of the final score
3. PROJECT: project proposal simulation
   - 40% of the final score

Exam – the test

- **6 open-ended questions**
  - **based on the course's materials** (the compulsory ones)
  - required to show understanding of the issues and to re-phrase concepts in their own words

Exam – the project

- Simulation of a project proposal
  - A proposal to Switch2Product (start-up)
- Output: a document (4-5 pages)
  - Groupwork: 4-5 people at most
  - Topic: to be agreed upon with the teacher
    - Something that at least one person in the group knows well

Exam – practical rules

- MOOC certificate: required
- TEST and PROJECT:
  - students need to score a sufficient grade in both, in order to pass
  - they can be done in different exam's sessionS

REMEMBER TO ENROLL when you are ready to get the final score!

The 3 credits version

- 3 credits version of the course:
  - MOOC=yes
  - 6 open-ended questions = yes
  - Project = NO

Contacts

- Mail:
  - nicoletta.diblas@polimi.it
  - giacomo.cassano@polimi.it
- Communications:
  - During the lessons' breaks
  - After the lesson
    - please send an e-mail the day before
    - **Subject: C&A_[whatever the topic is]**
  - …any other time, if you ask in advance

END